Macrina Hannah A. Morados

Macrina Hannah A. Morados is a Filipino Muslim legal scholar, educator, and public intellectual who has spent her career making Islamic law legible, just, and relevant, not just inside the classroom but in courtrooms, policy tables, and communities where it actually shapes people's lives. She holds the rank of **Associate Professor 7** at the UP Institute of Islamic Studies (UP IIS), University of the Philippines Diliman, and served as the institute's **8th Dean** from 2016 to 2018, becoming only the second woman in UP IIS history to hold that position. Her signature contribution is the bridge she has built between Islamic jurisprudence and Philippine law, particularly the Code of Muslim Personal Laws (Presidential Decree 1083), which governs the lives of millions of Filipino Muslims on matters of family, marriage, inheritance, and children's rights. Contextual evidence, including her foundational education at the Mindanao State University in Marawi City and her deep familiarity with Maranao communities and concerns, strongly suggests she is of Maranao heritage, though this has not been explicitly confirmed in publicly available sources.

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Background

Macrina A. Morados came of age academically in Marawi City, the heart of Maranao Muslim civilization in Mindanao. She completed her undergraduate education at Mindanao State University (MSU), one of the most significant centers of Islamic learning in the Philippines, earning her **Bachelor of Arts in Islamic Studies** in 1991 in MSU-General Santos. MSU's main campus sits within a predominantly Maranao environment, and the institution has historically been the alma mater of many prominent Muslim Filipino scholars, lawyers, and public servants. Her decision to pursue Islamic Studies there reflects both a personal rootedness in Muslim Filipino identity and an early intellectual commitment to understanding the intersection of faith, law, and community. She went on to earn her **Bachelor of Laws** at the MSU College of Law, Marawi Campus, completing her legal education in 2001. In March 2019, the Mindanao State University formally confirmed the retroactive elevation of her Bachelor of Laws to a **Juris Doctor** degree, aligning her credential with contemporary Philippine legal education standards. This confirmation, retroactive to 2001, recognized not just the formality of a title change but

the depth and rigor of legal training she had carried for nearly two decades. At present, she continues her academic journey as a doctoral candidate in Philippine Studies under the **UP Tri-College Program**, pursuing research on preventing and countering violent extremism among high-profile Muslim inmates in the Philippines.

Education

- **Bachelor of Arts in Islamic Studies**, Mindanao State University, Marawi City, 1991
- **Bachelor of Laws (retroactively confirmed as Juris Doctor)**, MSU College of Law, Marawi Campus, 2001 (JD confirmation issued March 6, 2019)
- **Doctoral Studies in Philippine Studies** (ongoing), University of the Philippines Tri-College Program
- **Shari'ah Bar**, passed 2008 (Islamic Inheritance Law) and 2014 (Persons and Family Relations)

Career

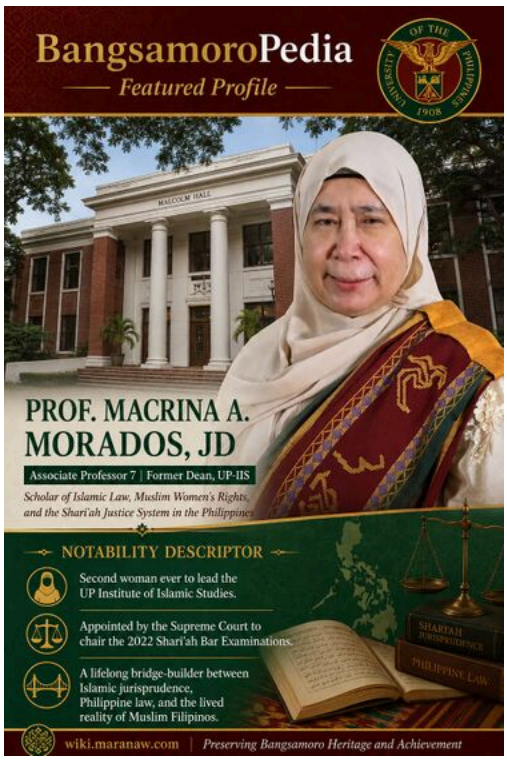
Academic Career at UP Diliman

Morados has built her academic home at the UP Institute of Islamic Studies, where she now holds the rank of **Associate Professor 7**. Her teaching and research spans a wide range of subjects: Muslim Personal and Family Relations Law, the Shari'ah Court system in the Philippines, Muslim women and children's rights, Islamic education, interfaith relations, theo-centrism and pluralism, and the history of Muslims in the Philippines. She served as **Dean of the UP IIS** with a three-year term beginning January 1, 2016, affirmed by UP Diliman Chancellor Michael L. Tan on March 30, 2016. As the second woman ever to lead the institute (following Dr. Carmen Abubakar), her deanship was marked by an ambitious agenda: curriculum reform to respond to global trends in Islamic banking, Halal, and Shari'ah studies; revival of the IIS academic journal; and the strengthening of the institute's role as a voice against extremism and radicalization. She was also a **Faculty Affiliate of the UP Center for International Studies** from 2015 to 2019, and served as **Convener of the UP Center for Integrative and Development Studies, Islamic Studies Program** (UP CIDS-ISP) from 2017 to 2021.

Role in the Shari'ah Justice System

Morados has been a trusted figure in the Philippine judiciary's engagement with Islamic law. She served as **Shari'ah Bar Examiner in 2008**, covering Islamic Inheritance Law, and again **in 2014**, covering Persons and Family Relations. In November 2021,

Macrina A. Morados



Personal Information	
Full Name	Macrina Hannah A. Morados
Ethnicity	Tausug
Religion	Islam
Nationality	Filipino
Education	
Undergraduate	BA in Islamic Studies, Mindanao State University-GenSan, 1991
Law Degree	Juris Doctor (retroactive), MSU College of Law, Marawi Campus, 2001 (confirmed 2019)
Graduate Studies	Doctoral Studies in Philippine Studies, UP Tri-College Program (ongoing)
Academic Positions	
Current Rank	Associate Professor 7, UP Institute of Islamic

by virtue of an En Banc Resolution of the Supreme Court of the Philippines, she was designated **Chairperson of the 2022 Shari'ah Bar Examinations**, the first time the examinations were held at UP Diliman since 1983. Apart from her examining role, she has served as a lecturer for the **PHILJA-NCMF Shari'ah Training Seminar** during the 18th and 19th Shari'ah Bar Examinations. She was also invited by the Philippine Judicial Academy (PHILJA) to participate in and lecture at the **Judges Career Enhancement Program**, where she delivered a comparative lecture on PD 1083 and the Civil Code on Persons and Family Relations for an audience of Shari'ah Court and Regional Trial Court judges in Tagaytay City (August 1 to 3, 2024). She currently serves as **Team Leader of the Supreme Court project** on the Institutional Review and Assessment of the Shariah Justice System, with outputs submitted in 2025.

Government and Policy Engagements

In 2015, she was appointed as a member of the **Transitional Justice and Reconciliation Commission (TJRC)** for the Historical Injustice Study Group, a body formed to address the roots of conflict in Muslim Mindanao as part of the peace process between the Philippine government and the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF). Her role in that commission was a recognition of her standing as a credible voice in Muslim Filipino affairs and her ability to situate historical grievances within the framework of law, justice, and reconciliation. In 2008, she received a **Cultural Exchange Program grant** under the Interfaith Program of the US Department of State and Purdue University, which broadened her engagement with international interfaith dialogue.

	Studies
Former Post	Dean, UP Institute of Islamic Studies (8th Dean; 2016-2018)
Affiliate	UP Center for International Studies (2015-2019)
Convener	UP CIDS Islamic Studies Program (2017-2021)
Notable Appointments	
2008 & 2014	Shari'ah Bar Examiner (Islamic Inheritance Law; Persons and Family Relations)
2015	Member, Transitional Justice and Reconciliation Commission (TJRC)
2021	Chairman, 2022 Shari'ah Bar Examinations (Supreme Court of the Philippines)
2025	Team Leader, Supreme Court Institutional Review of Shariah Justice System
Institution	University of the Philippines Diliman

Research and Publications

Morados is a prolific researcher whose published work consistently engages the real-world stakes of Islamic law in the Philippine context.

- **Muslim Personal Laws in the Philippines (PD 1083): A Policy Review using the Gender Perspective** (Lead Author, commissioned by the International Development Law Organization [IDLO], 2021) -- her most directly policy-oriented publication, applying gender analysis to the Code of Muslim Personal Laws.
- **Islamic Law and International Humanitarian Law: A Philippine Ulama Perspective on their Convergences and Divergences** (Co-author, UP IIS and ICRC, 2021) -- a scholarly contribution to the conversation between Islamic jurisprudence and international human rights frameworks.
- **Balik-Islam in Luzon and Metro Manila** (Co-author, in *Research on Balik-Islam in the Philippines*, IAG-UPIIS, 2020) -- examining the return to Islam among Filipino converts in urban and northern Philippine communities.
- **Philippine Muslim History: Challenges and Prospects** (Co-author, UP CIDS and UPIIS, 2019) -- a collaborative historiographical work addressing the contested and complex history of Filipino Muslims.
- **CRC and Islamic Law Divergences and Convergences: The Philippine Case** (Co-author, commissioned by UNICEF and the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos [NCMF], 2007) -- an early and influential contribution examining the compatibility of the Convention on the Rights of the Child with Islamic legal principles in the Philippine context.

She has also written opinion pieces in Philippine national media, including the *Philippine Daily Inquirer*, addressing issues such as the conceptual framework for rebuilding Marawi City as an Islamic community grounded in the principle of Tawheed.

Institutional Contributions

During her deanship of UP IIS, Morados articulated a clear vision for the institute as more than an academic unit; she saw it as a corrective voice in a national conversation too often distorted by misconception and fear. She advocated for the IIS to offer a major in Shari'ah and to develop Halal-related programs in response to growing global demand, framing both as opportunities for Filipino Muslims to participate meaningfully in national economic and legal life. She called for the revival of the IIS academic journal as a platform for balanced and liberating knowledge, particularly as a counterweight to the rise of radicalism and extremism. Through her work with UP CIDS-ISP, she helped institutionalize a space for interdisciplinary Islamic studies research within one of the Philippines' premier policy research centers. She has built a reputation as a go-to expert for media, international organizations, and government bodies seeking nuanced, informed perspectives on Muslim Filipino law, gender, and social issues.

Legacy

Macrina A. Morados represents a generation of Muslim Filipino women scholars who refused to be peripheral to the intellectual and policy conversations that shape their communities' lives. She has worn many hats: professor, dean, bar examiner, bar chair, policy reviewer, reconciliation commissioner, and public intellectual. In each of those roles, she has brought the same core conviction: that Islamic law, properly understood and justly applied, is compatible with human dignity, women's rights, and the aspirations of Filipino Muslims for peace and self-determination. Her research on Muslim personal law from a gender perspective, her advocacy for raising the minimum age of Muslim marriage, and her work on children's rights within Islamic jurisprudence mark her as a reformist scholar in the best tradition of Islamic legal thought. As she completes her doctorate and leads the Supreme Court's review of the Shariah justice system, her scholarly and institutional work continues to shape the legal landscape for Filipino Muslims.

Recognition

- Appointed as the **8th Dean** of the UP Institute of Islamic Studies (2016-2018), only the second woman to hold the position
- Designated **Chairman of the 2022 Shari'ah Bar Examinations** by the Supreme Court of the Philippines (2021)
- Member, **Transitional Justice and Reconciliation Commission (TJRC)**, Historical Injustice Study Group (2015)
- Recipient of a **US Department of State Cultural Exchange Program Grant** (Interfaith Program, Purdue University, 2008)
- Faculty Affiliate, **UP Center for International Studies** (2015-2019)
- Convener, **UP CIDS Islamic Studies Program** (2017-2021)
- Team Leader, **Supreme Court Institutional Review and Assessment of the Shariah Justice System** (output submitted 2025)

Current Research

Morados is presently finishing a research study on **Preventing and Countering Violent Extremism (P/CVE) among High-Profile Muslim Inmates in the Philippines**. This research sits at the intersection of her expertise in Islamic law, her long engagement with Muslim communities under stress, and the urgent national conversation on deradicalization and justice reform. It reflects her sustained commitment to research that is not merely academic but directly useful to the state, communities, and the people most affected by the policies she studies.

See Also

- Institute of Islamic Studies, University of the Philippines Diliman
- Code of Muslim Personal Laws (PD 1083)
- Shari'ah Bar Examinations (Philippines)
- Transitional Justice and Reconciliation Commission (Philippines)
- Bangsamoro
- Maranao people
- Muslim Filipinos
- University of the Philippines Diliman

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Categories

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